project.org

STUDENT HANDOUT

GREEN LEVEL
MORE SUPPORT

Why People Move: The Great Migration

Grades 5–8 · Social Studies

The Mini Museum

ADMIT ONE

NAME	DATE	CLASS

The Harlem Renaissance (c. 1920–1935) was an explosion of Black music, art, and literature in Harlem, New York, growing from the Great Migration of over one million Black Americans who moved north seeking better lives and opportunities.

01

ACTIVITY 1 · PUSH AND PULL FACTORS

Why Did People Leave — and Where Did They Go?

A **push factor** makes people want to leave a place. A **pull factor** draws people toward a new place. Sort each item below into the correct column:

- Jim Crow segregation laws
- Higher factory wages in the North
- Racial violence and lynching
- Better schools for children
- Sharecropping debt traps
- Black communities already established in Northern cities

PUSH — REASONS TO LEAVE THE SOUTH	PULL — REASONS TO MOVE NORTH

02

ACTIVITY 2 · THE MIGRATION ROUTE

Trace the Journey

The Great Migration Map in the exhibition shows the journey from the Mississippi Delta to Harlem. Using the map, label the six cities on the route and draw an arrow showing the direction of travel:

Mississippi Delta | New Orleans | Memphis | St. Louis | Chicago | Harlem, New York

SKETCH A SIMPLE MAP OF THE USA — LABEL CITIES AND DRAW THE ROUTE WITH AN ARROW

03

ACTIVITY 3 · IN THEIR OWN WORDS

What Would You Write?

Imagine you are a 12-year-old in Mississippi in 1920. Your family has just decided to move north. Write a short letter to your best friend explaining why you are leaving and what you hope to find. Use at least two push factors and one pull factor from Activity 1.

Dear _____ ,

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Your friend, _____

MINI MUSEUM CONNECTION

Option 1 — Visit the exhibition: If the Harlem Renaissance exhibition is available at your school, visit the Mini Museum to experience the phonograph, Jazz Lab, Great Migration Map, and more. Ask your librarian to arrange a class visit.

Option 2 — Virtual visit: minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/harlem-renaissance

SHARE WITH YOUR FAMILY

Explore the Great Migration Map at **minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/harlem-renaissance** with your family. Trace the journey together and discuss: where did your own family come from? What did they carry?